



EDMUND G. BROWN JR.
GOVERNOR



MATTHEW RODRIGUEZ
SECRETARY FOR
ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

26 September 2017

WDID: 5A321022001

Mr. Steve Leal, Facility Manager
Grizzly Creek Ranch
5900 Grizzly Road
Portola, CA 96122

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Mr. Dave Thomas, President
Sierra Nevada Journeys
190 East Liberty Street
Reno, NV 89501

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NOTICE OF APPLICABILITY (NOA), WATER QUALITY ORDER 2014-0135-DWQ-R5246, GRIZZLY CREEK RANCH, WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL SYSTEM, PLUMAS COUNTY

On 15 September 2017 Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Valley Water Board) staff inspected the wastewater facilities at Grizzly Creek Ranch (hereafter "Discharger") located at Grizzly Road & HWY 70 in Portola, Plumas County.

Based on the site inspection and a case file review, the facility treats and disposes of less than 100,000 gallons of wastewater per day, and is therefore eligible for coverage under the general and specific conditions of State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) Water Quality Order 2014-0153-DWQ General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems (General Order). This letter serves as formal notice that the General Order is applicable to your facility and the wastewater discharge described below. You are hereby assigned General Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5246 for your facility. You can also find the General Order on the State Water Board's website at:

http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

You should familiarize yourself with the entire General Order and its attachments that you were given during your 22 August 2017 inspection, which prescribes mandatory discharge and monitoring requirements. Sampling, monitoring, and reporting requirements that are applicable to your treatment and disposal methods must be completed in accordance with the sections of the General Order and the attached Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP). This MRP was developed after consideration of your treatment system infrastructure and site conditions described in the attached Technical Memorandum.

REGULATORY BACKGROUND

The Discharger's wastewater treatment and disposal system is currently regulated under the individual Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Order 99-140. The WDR was adopted on 29 October 1999 and is due for an update.

FACILITY AND DESCRIPTION

The Grizzly Creek Ranch was established as the entity responsible for the operation and maintenance of the wastewater treatment system for this facility. Sierra Nevada Journeys owns the property on which Grizzly Creek Ranch has been established. Originally the site was planned for 300 commonly owned duplex and four-plex units and resort services buildings, including RV and camp sites with an estimated discharge of 71,000 gallon per day (gpd). However that concept model failed with the collapse of the real-estate market and the development was sold to Sierra Health foundation, a non-profit organization that then developed the property as an educational retreat center. After 15 years of operation, 18 ranch Units, a lodge, and pool with a changing/bathroom facility have been constructed at the facility.

The Discharger currently has a seasonal average discharge of 15,500 gpd, of domestic wastewater to a septic tank effluent pump (STEP) system for wastewater collection. The community system consists of eight large common septic tanks with pump chambers and submersible pumps discharging to an equalization tank and then to two recirculating sand filters prior to discharge to two disposal ponds or a seasonal land application area.

Grizzly Creek Ranch is located in Sections 17, 20, 21, 28 and 29, T23N, R14E, MDB&M with surface water drainage to Grizzly Creek, as shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and part of the Order by reference. The site lies within the Middle Fork Feather River Hydraulic Sub Area No. 518.33 as depicted on interagency hydrologic maps prepared by the Department of Water Resources in August 1986.

FACILITY SPECIFIC REQUIREMENTS

The Discharger will maintain exclusive control over the discharge, and shall comply with the terms and conditions of this NOA and the General Order 2014-0153-DWQ-R5246, with all attachments.

Additionally the General Order states in Section B.1.L that the discharger shall comply with the setbacks as described in Table 3. This table summarizes different setback requirements for wastewater system equipment, activities, land application areas, and storage and/or treatment ponds from sensitive receptors and property lines where applicable. The Discharger shall comply with the following applicable setback requirements as summarized in the following table.

Table 3: Summary of Wastewater System Setbacks

Site Specific Applicable Setback Requirements					
Equipment or Activity	Domestic Well	Flowing Stream ^a	Ephemeral Stream Drainage ^b	Property Line	Lake or Reservoir ^d
Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System ^e	150 ft. ^y	N/A	50 ft.	5 ft. ^{c, z}	200 ft. ^w

Wastewater Storage and/or Treatment Ponds					
Impoundment (disinfected sec-2.2 or sec-23 recycled water) ^h	100 ft. ^r	100 ft.	100 ft.	50 feet	200 ft. ^w
Land Application Area Requirements					
LAA (undisinfected secondary recycled water) ⁱ	150 ft. ^s	100 ft.	100 ft.	100 ft. ^x 50 ft. ^p	200 ft.

N/A denotes Not Applicable, as the defined feature is not found within the general area of the facility.

- ^a A flowing stream shall be measured from the ordinary high water mark established by fluctuations of water elevation and indicated by characteristics such as shelving, changes in soil character, vegetation type, presence of litter or debris, or other appropriate means.
- ^b Ephemeral Stream Drainage denotes a surface water drainage feature that flows only after rain or snow-melt and does not have sufficient groundwater seepage (baseflow) to maintain a condition of flowing surface water. The drainage shall be measured from a line that defines the limit of the ordinary high water mark (described in "a" above). Irrigation canals are not considered ephemeral streams drainage features. The ephemeral stream shall be a "losing stream" (discharging surface water to groundwater) at the proposed wastewater system site.
- ^c Setback established by California Plumbing Code, Table K-1.
- ^d Lake or reservoir boundary measured from the high water line.
- ^e Septic Tank, Aerobic Treatment Unit, Treatment System, or Collection System addresses equipment located below ground or that impedes leak detection by routine visual inspection.
- ^h Disinfected secondary-2.2 recycled water is defined in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60301.220. Disinfected secondary-23 recycled water is defined in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60301.225.
- ⁱ Undisinfected secondary recycled water is defined in California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60301.900.
- ^p Setback for drip or flood application methods. Spray irrigation is subject to additional setbacks and restrictions. (See footnote k.)
- ^w Setback established by the Onsite Wastewater Treatment System Policy, section 7.5.5.
- ^x Setback established by California Code of Regulations, title 22, section 60310(f).
- ^y Setback established by Onsite Wastewater Treatment System Policy, section 7.5.6.
- ^z Collection system to property line setback is not applicable.

Failure to comply with the requirements in the documents could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code. Discharge of wastes other than those described in this NOA is prohibited. If the method of waste disposal changes from that described in this NOA, you must submit a new Report of Waste Discharge describing the new operation.

The required annual fee specified in the annual billing from the State Water Board shall be paid until this NOA is officially terminated. You must notify this office in writing if the discharge regulated by the General Order ceases, so that we may terminate coverage and avoid unnecessary billing.

The Central Valley Water Board has gone to a Paperless Office System. All regulatory documents, MRPs, submissions, materials, data, monitoring reports, and correspondence

Steve Leal
Grizzly Creek Ranch

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should be converted to a searchable Portable Document Format (PDF) and submitted electronically. Documents that are less than 50MB should be emailed to:

centralvalleyredding@waterboards.ca.gov.

Documents that are 50MB or larger should be transferred to a disc and mailed to the appropriate regional water board office, in this case 364 Knollcrest Drive, Suite 205, Redding, CA 96002. To ensure that your submittals are routed to the appropriate staff, the following information block should be included in any email used to transmit documents to this office:

Program: Non-15

WDID: 5A320104003

Facility Name: Grizzly Creek Ranch

Order: 2014-0153-DWQ-R5246

Please note that WDRs Order No. 99-140 is proposed to be rescinded at the 7/8 December 2017 meeting of the Central Valley Water Board. Upon rescission of your individual WDRs, coverage for your facility under the General Order shall go into affective subject to this Notice of Applicability.

If you have any questions regarding submitting an updated report of waste discharge, making changes to your permitted operations, compliance or enforcement please contact Ron S. Falkowski at (530) 224-3227, rsfalkowksi@waterboards.ca.gov, or the footer address.


PAMELA C. CREEDON
Executive Officer

RSF: hs: db

Attachments: Attachment A – Site Location Map
Attachment B – Facility Map
Technical Memorandum
Monitoring and Reporting Program

cc w/o enc: Tim O'Brien, State Water Board, Sacramento
Plumas County Environmental Health Department, Quincy
Patrick Pulupa, SWRCB, Office of Chief Counsel, Sacramento